

new image onto the ROM. You can also install custom kernels which lower CPU voltages and save power. Custom ROMs and rooting also allows you to overclock your processor in case you want to eek out the maximum performance from your CPU. XDA Developers is an excellent forum where



CyanogenMod

you'll get a host of resource for rooting and customizing your device.

iOS devices are a different story, you need to jailbreak the phone and unlock the bootloader which will allow you to install custom images. You can install a different version of iOS or a different OS altogether. For eg. iDroid for running Android on your iDevice. It is based on Bootrom exploits which allowing the running of unsigned code at low level.

There has been a huge progress in the bootloader unlockers and custom ROMs for Windows Phone devices in the last couple of months. XDA threads are a flood with custom ROMs for Windows Phone 7.8 along with unlocked bootloaders and custom ROMs for high-end smartphones like HTC Titan and Radar. You'll find a lot of details over at WPCentral (<http://www.wpcentral.com/tags/custom-roms>) which keeps a close eye on the happenings in this area.

We did a huge section in last month's (June 2013) Tips and Tricks called 'Hack your Smartphone' which detailed a lot of methods by which you can root/jailbreak your device to load a custom image of the operating system. It's an excellent place to get started, it also has links in the post-rooting section which describe in detail how to install custom ROM images for each of the above mentioned platform. Please note that the instructions mentioned in the article for rooting smartphones hold true for tablets as well. 